

La Cucina — The Language of the Italian Table

Capsule Culturale · La Cucina · Cultural · Any level · 6 sessions × 60 min

The Promise

Six live cultural sessions on the vocabulary and history of the Italian table — pasta, pane, vino, caffè, and the sacred rituals of the family meal.

On Completion, You Can:

- › Read any Italian recipe with confidence
- › Understand a regional Italian menu at a glance
- › Talk knowledgeably about pasta shape, sauce and region
- › Discuss the history of Italian coffee, wine and olive oil
- › Understand the ritual grammar of the Italian Sunday lunch
- › Order, cook and discuss food in Italian at a cultured level

The Syllabus — Week by Week

Lesson 01 · La geografia del cibo

How Italy's twenty regions produced twenty cuisines. The north-south axis of butter vs olive oil, rice vs pasta, wine vs beer.

Lesson 02 · La pasta — mille forme, mille storie

Four hundred pasta shapes. Why bucatini all'amatriciana can only be bucatini. The unwritten pasta rules.

Lesson 03 · Il pane e il forno

The vocabulary of bread — pane sciapo, pagnotta, michetta, focaccia. The village bakery as institution.

Lesson 04 · Il vino italiano

Twenty regions, twenty wine cultures. Reading a label, understanding DOC and DOCG, the ritual of the tasting.

Lesson 05 · Il caffè — un rito

The Italian relationship with coffee, from Trieste to Naples. The bar, the moka, the caffettiera.

Lesson 06 · Il pranzo della domenica

The most sacred meal in Italian life. Six courses, three hours, one grandmother. Cultural graduation.

